- Write once, deploy many times
- No manual configurations
- No inconsistencies in environment
- Standardised run time environment; application deployment, middleware and databases

Chef and the Amazon public cloud

Chef and Amazon public cloud integration makes infrastructure fast and agile. The *knife-ec2* plug-in is used to integrate AWS and Chef. It allows cloud consumers to launch and configure EC2 instances, to create base Amazon Machine Images, to register EC2 instances with Elastic Load Balancers, to manage EBS volumes and raid devices. It is very easy to spin off a Windows 2012 server, configure IIS and deploy a .NET app in AWS with the use of Chef, which provides speed and efficiency with standard environments. In AWS, it is very easy to maximise the uptime of the Chef server by taking advantage of Chef's integration with Amazon's elastic block storage and elastic IPs. Different AWS regions can also be used to gain high availability.

Comparisons between Chef and Puppet

Here's a comparison of two configuration management tools—Chef and Puppet, which will enable you to take an informed decision based on the needs and expertise your organisation has in using Chef or Puppet.

	Chef	Puppet
Type	Configuration management, private and public cloud management, DevOps, continuous deployment or delivery	Configuration management, private and public cloud management, DevOps
Licence	Apache licence	Apache from 2.7.0, GPL before that
Language	Ruby (client) and Erlang (server); uses domain-specific language (DSL)	Ruby
Platform support	AIX, *BSD, HP-UX, Linux, Mac OS X, Solaris, Windows *http://docs.getchef.com/install_server.html*	AIX, *BSD, HP-UX, Linux, Mac OS X (partial), Solaris, Windows *https://docs.puppetlabs.com/guides/platforms.html*
Developer base	Growing fast	Huge
Architecture	Chef server, Chef agents, and a Chef workstation for configuration and management	Puppet server and Puppet agents for configuration and management
Agent based	Yes	Yes
Stable release	Ver 11.10.4; February 20, 2014	Ver 3.7.1; September 15, 2014
Community base	Comparatively smaller user base	Large user base
DevOps support	Programmer-friendly approach	Systems admin-friendly approach
Integration with cloud- based platforms	Amazon EC2, VMware, OpenStack, Rackspace, Google Cloud Platform, and Microsoft Azure; it supports automatic provisioning/de-provisioning and configuration of new machines.	Bare metal, VMware, OpenStack, Eucalyptus Cloud, Google Compute Engine, Amazon EC2
Main customers	Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, Splunk, Rackspace, GE Capital, Digital Science, Bloomberg	Twitter, Verizon, VMware, Sony, Symantec, Red Hat, Salesforce, Motorola, PayPal
Company	Opscode	Puppet Labs
Documentation	Good	Very Good
Website	*www.getchef.com*	*http://puppetlabs.com*
Documentation	*http://docs.opscode.com/*	*http://docs.puppetlabs.com/*

END

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By: Priyanka Agashe and Mitesh Soni

Priyanka Agashe is a Software Engineer. She loves to explore new technologies and her professional spheres of interests include Oracle Apps, Electronics, and Robotics.

Mitesh Soni is a Technical Lead in the same organisation. He is in the Cloud Practice and loves to write about new technologies. Blog: *http://clean-clouds.com*